

INFORMATICS INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

BSc (Hons) Computer Science

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Verbs

Verbs are words that show action or state of being in a sentence. They can be identified by looking for the words that describe what someone or something does, has, or is. For example, in the sentence “She runs every morning”, the verb is “runs” because it shows the action of the subject “she”.

Find the word in a sentence that describes action. Basically, verbs are action words. They describe someone or something performing an action. Start by looking at a sentence and identifying the action words. If there are more than one, underline all of them. For example, in the sentence “He plays the guitar and sings beautifully”, the verbs are “plays” and “sings” because they show the actions of the subject “he”.

Remember common verb suffixes if you can’t identify the action. Verbs often have distinct suffixes, or endings. Some common verb suffixes are -ed, -ing, -s, -es, -en, and -er. For example, in the sentence “She studied hard for the exam”, the verb is “studied” because it has the suffix -ed, which indicates the past tense of an action verb.

Learn the different verb tenses. Verbs are the only words that are conjugated or put into different forms. The verb tense shows the time of the action or state of being. There are three main verb tenses: past, present, and future. For example, in the sentence “She will study hard for the exam”, the verb is “will study” because it shows the future tense of an action verb.

Learn the different tenses of “to be”. The verb “to be” is the most common linking verb, which links the subject to a word that renames or describes the subject. The verb “to be” has different forms depending on the tense and the subject. For example, in the sentence “She is a girl”, the verb is “is” because it links the subject “she” to the predicate nominative “girl”.

Learn the different forms of “to have”. The verb “to have” is another common verb that can show action or ownership. The verb “to have” also has different forms depending on the tense and the subject. For example, in the sentence “She has a dog”, the verb is “has” because it shows the ownership of the subject “she”.

Learn the different forms of “to do”. The verb “to do” is another common verb that can show action or help other verbs. The verb “to do” also has different forms depending on the tense and the subject. For example, in the sentence “She does her homework every day”, the verb is “does” because it shows the action of the subject “she”.

Learn the different forms of modal verbs. Modal verbs are verbs that express possibility, necessity, permission, or ability. They are usually followed by another verb in the base form. Some common modal verbs are can, could, may, might, must, shall, should, will, and would. For example, in the sentence “She can play the piano”, the verb is “can play” because it shows the ability of the subject “she”. The modal verbs do not change their forms depending on the tense or the subject.

Adjectives

Adjectives can be used with nouns or pronouns to modify or describe them. Adjectives can be used in different ways depending on the position, number, and type of adjectives. Here are some general rules for using adjectives with nouns or pronouns:

Adjectives can be used before the noun or pronoun they modify. This is called the attributive position. For example, “She has a big house” or “He is a kind person”.

Adjectives can also be used after the noun or pronoun they modify, usually with a linking verb such as to be, to feel, to seem, or to taste. This is called the predicative position. For example, “The house is big” or “He seems kind”.

Adjectives can be used in the comparative form to compare two things. This is usually done by adding the suffix -er or the word more before the adjective. For example, “She has a bigger house than him” or “He is more kind than her”.

Adjectives can be used in the superlative form to indicate that something has the most or least of a quality. This is usually done by adding the suffix -est or the word most before the adjective. For example, “She has the biggest house in the neighborhood” or “He is the most kind person I know”.

Adjectives can be used in a coordinate way to modify the same noun or pronoun with two or more adjectives. This is usually done by separating the adjectives with a comma or a conjunction such as and. For example, “She has a big, beautiful house” or “He is a kind and generous person”.

Adjectives can also be used with other parts of speech, such as verbs, prepositions, and other adjectives. Here are some examples of how adjectives can be used with these parts of speech:

Adjectives can be used with verbs to modify the verb or the object of the verb. For example, “She quickly ran to the store” or “He carefully painted the wall”.

Adjectives can be used with prepositions to modify the preposition or the object of the preposition. For example, “She lives near the park” or “He is from a small town”.

Adjectives can be used with other adjectives to modify the same noun or pronoun. This is usually done by using a hyphen to connect the adjectives. For example, “She has a well-known author” or “He is a hard-working student”.

Adverbs

An adverb is a word that can modify or describe a verb, adjective, another adverb, or an entire sentence. Adverbs can be used to show manner (how something happens), degree (to what extent), place (where), and time (when). For example, in the sentence “She ran quickly to the store”, the word “quickly” is an adverb because it modifies the verb “ran” and shows how she ran.

Adverbs are usually formed by adding -ly to the end of an adjective (e.g., “quick” becomes “quickly”), although there are also other adverbs that don’t have this ending. Some adverbs use the same form as their corresponding adjectives. These are known as flat adverbs (e.g., “straight”, “fast”, “early”). Other adverbs (e.g., “never”) simply don’t have a corresponding adjective.

Adverbs can also be used to modify entire sentences by expressing a viewpoint or making an evaluation. These adverbs (called sentence adverbs) are typically set off with commas. For example, "Luckily, the fire department responded immediately."

Prepositions

A preposition is a word that shows the relationship between a noun or a pronoun and another word in a sentence. Prepositions can indicate direction, location, time, or purpose. For example, in the sentence “She went to the store”, the word “to” is a preposition that shows the direction of her movement. Some other common prepositions are at, by, for, from, in, of, on, with, and about. Prepositions usually come before the noun or pronoun they modify, but sometimes they can come at the end of a sentence. For example, in the sentence “What are you looking for?”, the word “for” is a preposition that comes at the end.

Tenses

01. Past tense: The past tense is used to talk about things that happened or existed before the present time. For example, "I went to the park yesterday."

- Past simple: The past simple is used to talk about completed actions or states in the past. For example, "She studied hard for the exam."
- Past continuous: The past continuous is used to talk about actions or states that were in progress at a specific time in the past. For example, "He was sleeping when the phone rang."
- Past perfect: The past perfect is used to talk about actions or states that happened before another past action or state. For example, "She had already left when I arrived."
- Past perfect continuous: The past perfect continuous is used to talk about actions or states that started and continued up to a point in the past. For example, "They had been working on the project for two months before they finished it."

02. Present tense: The present tense is used to talk about things that are happening or existing now or around now. For example, "I am at the park right now."

- Present simple: The present simple is used to talk about general facts, habits, routines, or schedules. For example, "She studies hard for every exam."
- Present continuous: The present continuous is used to talk about actions or states that are in progress at the moment of speaking or around now. For example, "He is sleeping right now."
- Present perfect: The present perfect is used to talk about actions or states that have a connection with the present. For example, "She has already left for school."
- Present perfect continuous: The present perfect continuous is used to talk about actions or states that started in the past and are still in progress or have just finished in the present. For example, "They have been working on the project for two months and they are almost done."

03. Future tense: The future tense is used to talk about things that will happen or exist in the future. For example, "I will go to the park tomorrow."

- Future simple: The future simple is used to talk about predictions, intentions, offers, promises, or decisions made at the moment of speaking. For example, "She will study hard for the next exam."
- Future continuous: The future continuous is used to talk about actions or states that will be in progress at a specific time in the future. For example, "He will be sleeping when I call him."
- Future perfect: The future perfect is used to talk about actions or states that will be completed before another future action or state. For example, "She will have left by the time I arrive."
- Future perfect continuous: The future perfect continuous is used to talk about actions or states that will start and continue up to a point in the future. For example, "They will have been working on the project for two months by the time they finish it."

Concrete Nouns and Abstract Nouns

Concrete nouns are nouns that refer to physical things, people, or places that can be perceived with the five senses. For example, pencil, dog, Timbuktu, and Patricia are concrete nouns. Concrete nouns are contrasted with abstract nouns, which are words that describe concepts that you can't perceive directly with the senses. For example, politeness, love, freedom, and democracy are abstract nouns.

An abstract noun is a word that names something that is not physical or concrete. It refers to an idea, quality, state, or concept that you cannot see, touch, hear, smell, or taste. For example, happiness, freedom, love, and justice are abstract nouns. Abstract nouns are different from concrete nouns, which are words that name something that is physical or concrete. For example, chair, dog, apple, and Paris are concrete nouns.

Count Nouns and Mass Nouns

A count noun is a noun that can be modified by a quantity and that occurs in both singular and plural forms, and that can co-occur with quantificational determiners like every, each, several, etc. For example, book, dog, and city are count nouns because you can say one book, two dogs, three cities, every book, each dog, several cities, and so on. Contrast with mass noun (or noncount noun), which is a noun that cannot be modified by a quantity and that only occurs in singular form, and that cannot co-occur with quantificational determiners.

Mass nouns are nouns that refer to things that cannot be counted or divided into separate units. They usually describe substances, concepts, or activities that are not easily measured or quantified. For example, water, music, and homework are mass nouns. Mass nouns are different from count nouns, which are nouns that can be counted and have singular and plural forms. For example, book, dog, and city are count nouns. Mass nouns have some grammatical features that distinguish them from count nouns. For example, mass nouns:

Cannot be modified by a number or an indefinite article (a or an). For example, you cannot say "one water" or "a music".

Cannot be pluralized. For example, you cannot say "waters" or "musics".

Can be modified by words like some, any, much, or little. For example, you can say "some water" or "little music".

Can be quantified by using a unit of measurement or a partitive expression. For example, you can say "two liters of water" or "a piece of music".

Phrasal Verbs

A phrasal verb is a phrase or expression that consists of a verb plus another word or two, such as an adverb or a preposition. The whole phrase acts as a verb, and has a different meaning from the original verb. For example, look up, look after and look forward to do not mean the same as look. Phrasal verbs are very common in spoken English, but less common in formal written English. **The verb in phrasal verbs always takes tense.**

A Proper Nouns

A proper noun is a word that names a specific person, place, thing, or idea. It is always capitalized in English, no matter where it appears in a sentence. For example, John, Paris, Microsoft, and Buddhism are proper nouns. Proper nouns are different from common nouns, which are words that name general or generic types of people, places, things, or ideas. For example, man, city, company, and religion are common nouns.

Compound Nouns

A compound noun is a noun that is made up of two or more words that work together as a single unit to name a person, place, thing, or idea. For example, basketball, firefly, and mother-in-law are compound nouns. Compound nouns can be formed by combining different parts of speech, such as noun + noun, noun + verb, adjective + noun, and so on. Compound nouns can also be written in different ways, such as with a space, a hyphen, or no space between the words. For example, bus stop, by-product, blackbird, and sunflower are different types of compound nouns.

Definite and Indefinite Articles

Definite and indefinite articles are words that are used before nouns to indicate whether they are specific or general. The definite article is the word the, and it is used to refer to a particular noun that is known or identified by the speaker or the listener. For example, “the sun” refers to the specific star that we see in the sky, and “the book” refers to a particular book that has been mentioned or shown before. The indefinite articles are the words a and an, and they are used to refer to a nonspecific noun that is not known or identified by the speaker or the listener. For example, “a sun” refers to any star that is similar to ours, and “a book” refers to any book that has not been mentioned or shown before. The indefinite article a is used before nouns that start with a consonant sound, and the indefinite article an is used before nouns that start with a vowel sound. For example, “a dog” and “an apple”. **We do not use the definite or indefinite article before countable and abstract nouns in a general sense.**